



SCANNERS

Scanners have come a long way. Today, entry-level scanners spin their magic at well over 1,200 dpi, and are affordable, slim, and good-looking. They do well at multitasking too—a scanner can, for example, e-mail or print a scanned document, or even burn a copy of it onto a CD—all in a matter of minutes. It has thus been elevated to the status of a smart companion from just a mono-task device. Moreover, technology such as Contact Image Sensors (CIS) makes for space-saving design, without scrimping on quality.

Although the scanner is not on the list of hardware to see major technological changes, these devices can now scan at a resolution of 2400 x 4800 dpi and at a colour bit-depth of 48. Subtle changes in the way sensors are built have also helped the scanner reproduce better results in shorter times.

With a resolution of 2,400 dpi and 48-bit colour depth, the sleek HP 4570c brings eye-pleasing images to your monitor. It also has a connector for the Transparency Adapter. The scanner has a

HP 4570c

- + 4 hot keys, bundled automatic document feeder, good after-sales support
- No transport lock

Price: Rs 17,999

Contact: Hewlett-Packard India Ltd

Phone: 011-2682 6000

E-mail: ashwini-k_aggarwal@hp.com

Reviewed in: April 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: Hp Scanjet 5470c

2001: Epson 1640SU

USB interface, which means that getting it up and running is a piece of cake. The quality delivered and the features that it offers are further backed by the results of the speed test, which are testament to its efficiency.

Features such as scan to CD, print

WORTHY MENTIONS

HP Scanjet 3500c

- + 3 hot keys, good after-sales support
- No transport lock, high pre-scan time

Price: Rs 6,200

Contact: Hewlett-Packard India Ltd

Phone: 011-2682 6000

E-mail: ashwini-k_aggarwal@hp.com

Reviewed in: April 2003

Umax Astra 2500

- + OCR software bundled, very fast photo-scanning at high resolutions
- No onboard controls

Price: Rs 3,600

Contact: Neoteric

Phone: 022-2417 2600

Fax: 022-2418 5294

E-mail: sales@neoteric-info.com

Reviewed in: April 2003

and e-mail, and a key to select colour and line art mode make it very easy to use. The build quality and looks are just as good, making it a perfect tool for those who can afford it.

SPEAKERS

From being mere add-ons to a peripheral even a home user does not ignore, speakers have come a long way. With interactive games and DVD movies becoming increasingly popular, it comes as no surprise that speakers have evolved to reproduce crisper, sharper audio. High-end, sophisticated equipment not only reproduces but also enhances the audio quality. This year saw quite a few entrants in the speaker category. The tests covered the entire gamut, ranging from the spanking new Creative Inspire 7.1 to the thunderous Creative Megaworks 5.1 550. The monstrous Altec Lansing 641 speakers were also reviewed.

This year's winner was the Creative Megaworks THX 5.1 550. The beauty of these speakers lies in its acoustics. They are clear and loud enough to give you an overwhelming experience. The bass provides the needed effect for trance and bass-intensive music. Turn down the bass and play a live orchestra track to witness these speakers produce the most

Creative Megaworks THX 5.1 550

- + Huge power output, distortion-free sound even at high volumes
- No digital input, expensive

Price: Rs 27,999

Contact: Creative Technology Ltd

Phone: 98203 57713

Email: rajshekhar_bhatt@ctl.creative.com

Reviewed In: April 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: Artis S880

2001: Creative Cambridge DTT 2500D

soothing high-fidelity sound that gives you the ambience of a live concert. This THX-certified product captures the sound effects of a movie with aplomb and verve. On the flip side, it has no provision for connecting a digital input to the speakers. But this omission can be

WORTHY MENTIONS

Altec Lansing 641 4.1 speakers

- + Lots of options on the remote, tight bass
- Weak mid-range, sub-woofer overpowers the satellites at higher volumes

Price: Rs 20,000

Contact: Zeta Technologies

Phone: 022-2410 2277

E-mail: tejas@zetaindia.com

Reviewed In: December 2003

Creative Inspire T7700 7.1 speakers

- + Has a connector for the Creative MuVo MP3 player on the wired remote control
- Subwoofer is underpowered, noticeable distortion at high volumes

Price: Rs 12,299

Contact: Creative Technology Ltd

Phone: 98203 57713

E-mail: rajshekhar_bhatt@ctl.creative.com

Reviewed In: December 2003

disregarded in the light of the superb sound quality that these speakers are capable of. →